Course Generative AI Policy

Overview

This course permits and encourages the use of large language models (LLMs) and other generative AI tools in completing assignments. You may use these tools in any way you see fit—for brainstorming, code generation, debugging, explanation, drafting, editing, or any other purpose that advances your work.

Requirements for Use

When using generative AI tools, you must fulfill two requirements:

1. Provide a Transcript

Submit a complete transcript of your interactions with any LLM used in completing an assignment. This transcript must include all prompts you provided and the responses you received. Most platforms allow you to export or copy conversation histories; screenshots are also acceptable.

2. Cite the Models Used

Include a citation for each AI tool you used. Citations should specify the model name, version (if known), the developer, and the date of access.

Example Citations

- OpenAI. (2025). ChatGPT (Version 5.2) [Large language model]. https://chat.openai.com. Accessed January 8, 2026.
- Google DeepMind. (2025). Gemini 3 Flash [Large language model]. https://gemini.google.com. Accessed January 8, 2026.
- Anthropic. (2025). Claude Opus 4.5 [Large language model]. https://claude.ai. Accessed January 8, 2026.

Free Access to AI Tools

All students have free access to Google Gemini through their university accounts. You are encouraged to take advantage of this resource throughout the course. Here is the link: https://search.app/RdW9w

A Note on LLMs, Learning, and Professional Development

This course has two goals: **to build foundational knowledge** in data science methods and concepts, and to help you **deliver excellent work product**. Your grade is determined solely by the quality of the work you submit.

However, the way you choose to interact with LLMs will have a profound effect on your ability to build and extend the foundational knowledge you need for long-term success in this field.

Consider the difference between asking an LLM to "write code that does X" versus asking it to "explain the intuition behind algorithm Y, then walk me through how I might implement it step by step." Both approaches may produce a working solution, but only one builds your capacity to solve novel problems independently, to recognize when an AI-generated answer is subtly wrong, and to push the boundaries of what's possible in your future work.

You are training to be experts. Experts understand why things work, not just that they work. Use these tools in ways that serve your development as a practitioner—not just your grade on any single assignment.

The transcripts you submit are not graded for "correct" usage. They are required so that you develop the habit of reflection and transparency, and so that you can look back on your own learning process over time.